Siddhi. He may have been perceived as anti-politician, but truthfully, he had friends in all political parties.

Kejriwal, by contrast, was the archetypal angry young rebel, looking for a cause. There was a single-minded, almost manic, determination that seemed to guide his moves. '*Unme ek desh ke liye kuch karne ka paagalpan hai* [He is obsessed with doing something for the country], which is his strength and his weakness,' is how an admirer described Kejriwal to me. An old-time NGO associate, though, insisted that a highly ambitious Kejriwal had a habit of using people and then discarding them. 'Anna is only a stepping stone in Arvind's own journey,' is how he described the relationship. My own sense was that Kejriwal and Anna were both headstrong individuals—a clash was inevitable once the original fervour of the Lok Pal movement died down.

Salman Khurshid, the former Union minister who negotiated with Team Anna during the Lok Pal movement, says the differences in the team were apparent right from the beginning. 'You spoke to Kiran Bedi and she would say one thing; you spoke to Arvind, he would say something else. And rarely did they have a nice word to say about each other,' he claims.

In July 2012, the government had begun backchannel talks with Anna through friendly politicians and businessmen in Pune. Khurshid met Anna and convinced him that the government would support the Lok Pal in Parliament. 'He even agreed to campaign for the Congress as part of the deal,' says Khurshid. A letter was drafted by the prime minister's office to thank Anna and put a stamp on the agreement. But then in a last-minute twist, the letter meant for Anna was dispatched to Kejriwal's residence by mistake. Or so the government claimed. Kejriwal was furious. He had been taking on the Congress and here was Anna striking a deal with them. Anna was embarrassed as well. He apparently called up Kejriwal that evening, saying, 'We must teach the Congress a lesson, they are practising the politics of divide and rule!'

Anna decided to go on another fast, this time calling for an FIR to be registered against fifteen UPA ministers. On day nine of the fast, he made a public appeal to Kejriwal to form a political party. Kejriwal, who had